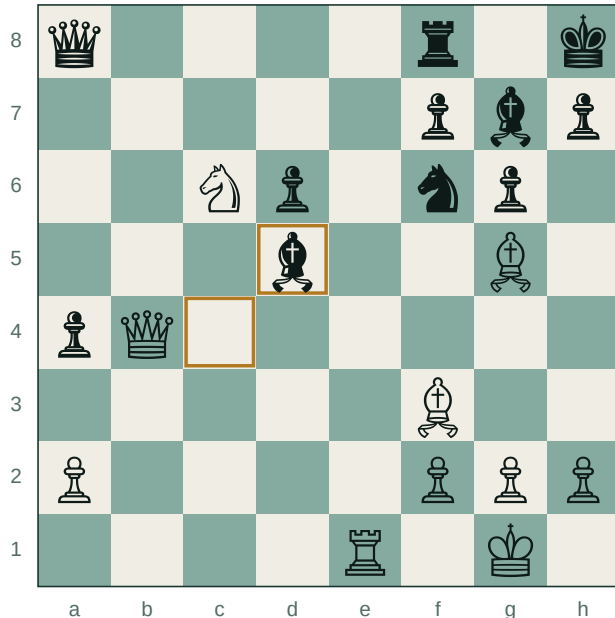


Attraction tactics: White, move 24

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 23...Bxd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. Bxf6 Bxc6 25. Bxg7+ Kxg7 26. Qc3+

24.Bxf6 The bishop captures the knight on f6. Recorded reply: **24...Bxc6**.

25.Bxg7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From g7 it attacks king on h8 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **25...Kxg7**.

26.Qc3+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From c3 it attacks king on g7 and bishop on c6.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.